

LEAN BULK

More fuel. Same **structure.**

A high-protein surplus for people who want stronger sessions without losing the shape of their week. Real food, real portions, and a plan you can hold for three months instead of three days.

High protein

6 recipes

Training-day fuelling

Snacks that count

+300–500

KCAL SURPLUS

1.6–2.2g

PROTEIN / KG

0.25–0.5%

BODYWEIGHT / WEEK

LEAN, NOT LOOSE

A surplus is a **small** number, held for a **long** time.

A lean bulk is boring on purpose. Three to five hundred calories above maintenance, protein high enough to build with, and enough patience to let 0.25–0.5% of your bodyweight a week add up. Bigger surpluses don't build muscle faster — they just add more of the other thing.

DAILY TARGETS BY BODYWEIGHT

BODYWEIGHT	PROTEIN	SURPLUS	ROUGH DAILY TOTAL	WEEKLY GAIN
60 kg	100–130 g	+300–400 kcal	2 400–2 700 kcal	150–300 g
70 kg	115–150 g	+300–500 kcal	2 700–3 100 kcal	175–350 g
80 kg	130–175 g	+300–500 kcal	3 000–3 400 kcal	200–400 g
90 kg	145–195 g	+400–500 kcal	3 300–3 800 kcal	225–450 g

Daily totals assume moderate training 4–5 days a week. Start at the low end, hold it for two weeks, then adjust based on what the scale and the mirror actually do.

DO

Add calories to meals you already eat. An extra scoop of rice and a tablespoon of peanut butter is a surplus. It doesn't need a sixth meal.

DON'T

Chase the surplus with snacks you don't enjoy. If it's a chore at week two, it's abandoned by week six.

CHECK

Weigh in three mornings a week and use the weekly average. One day's number is noise, not information.



Bigger portions of **the same** food.

A lean bulk is a serving-spoon decision, not a whole new diet.

ONE TROLLEY • ONE PERSON • SEVEN DAYS

The surplus list.

Same skeleton as any other week, with the calorie-dense lines pushed up. Peanut butter, olive oil, full-cream milk and oats do most of the heavy lifting here — they add calories without adding volume you have to fight through.

PROTEIN

EST.

☐ Chicken breast fillets	1.5 kg	R190
☐ Lean beef mince	1 kg	R170
☐ Chicken thighs	1 kg	R95
☐ Eggs	30	R95
☐ Greek yoghurt	1 kg	R60

ENERGY-DENSE

EST.

☐ Oats	2 kg	R70
☐ Rice	2 kg	R45
☐ Peanut butter	1 kg	R95
☐ Full-cream milk	6 L	R110
☐ Olive or canola oil	750 ml	R70

PRODUCE

EST.

☐ Sweet potato	2 kg	R45
☐ Bananas	2 kg	R56
☐ Frozen mixed veg	2 kg	R64
☐ Spinach & peppers	mixed	R70

CUPBOARD & SNACKS

EST.

☐ Mixed nuts	500 g	R90
☐ Raisins / dried fruit	500 g	R55
☐ Tinned tomato ×4	—	R48

Trolley total

±R1 430

Roughly **R200 a day** for 3 000+ kcal and 150 g of protein.

Prices are typical South African shelf estimates and will vary by store, province and week. Protein powder is optional throughout this plan — every target here is reachable with food alone.

AROUND THE SESSION

Fuel the work. Then **feed the repair.**

Total daily protein and calories matter far more than timing. But on hard days, putting carbohydrate before the session and protein after it makes the next session better — and that compounding is the whole point.

1

2–3 hours before • a real meal

Chicken, rice and veg. Enough carbohydrate to train hard, far enough out that it isn't sitting on your chest during the first set.

2

30–60 minutes before • something small

A banana, a handful of raisins, or half a jar of oats. Optional if you ate well earlier — useful if you're training in the evening after a long day.

3

Within 2 hours after • 30–40 g protein

A bolognese box, a chicken bowl, or yoghurt with nuts. The window is far wider than the internet claims, but the habit is worth keeping.

4

Before bed • slow protein

Greek yoghurt or milk with peanut butter. Cheap, easy, and an effortless 20–25 g on top of the day.



Hard days earn **bigger plates.**

Eat more on training days, slightly less on rest days. The week averages out.

4–5×

PROTEIN FEEDS A
DAY

30–40g

PROTEIN PER FEED

3–4 L

WATER A DAY

7–9 hrs

SLEEP, NON-
NEGOTIABLE

The two meals doing **most of the work.**

540 KCAL

01

Beef & Veg Bolognese

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
540 kcal	34 g	5

YOU NEED • 5 SERVINGS

- 750 g lean beef mince
- 1 onion, 2 carrots, 1 courgette, grated
- 2 tins chopped tomato, 1 tbsp paste
- 500 g pasta, 2 tbsp olive oil
- Garlic, mixed herbs, 1 stock cube

METHOD

1. Soften the onion, carrot and courgette in the oil, 8 minutes.
2. Brown the mince hard before adding anything wet.
3. Add tomato, paste, stock and herbs; simmer 25 minutes uncovered.
4. Serve over pasta. For the surplus: bigger pasta portion, grated cheese on top.

Bulk it up: 100 g extra dry pasta and 30 g cheese adds roughly 480 kcal and 12 g protein.

45 G PROTEIN

02

Chicken, Rice & Roast Veg Bowl

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
520 kcal	45 g	4

YOU NEED • 4 SERVINGS

- 800 g chicken breast fillets
- 2½ cups rice, uncooked
- 2 peppers, 1 red onion, 1 courgette
- 3 tbsp olive oil, 1 tsp paprika
- Salt, pepper, lemon

METHOD

1. Oven to 200°C. Toss the veg in oil and paprika; roast 22 minutes.
2. Season and roast the chicken 20–24 minutes; rest before slicing.
3. Cook the rice and spread it on a tray to cool quickly.
4. Build the bowl and finish with a squeeze of lemon.

Bulk it up: An extra half-cup of cooked rice and a drizzle of olive oil is a clean +250 kcal.

Two more so week three **doesn't collapse.**



OVEN TRAY

03

Peri-Peri Chicken, Sweet Potato & Beans

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
480 kcal	38 g	4

YOU NEED • 4 SERVINGS

- 8 chicken thighs, skin on
- 1.2 kg sweet potato, cubed
- 500 g green beans
- 3 tbsp peri-peri, 2 tbsp olive oil
- Garlic, lemon, paprika

METHOD

1. Oven to 200°C. Marinate the thighs in peri-peri, garlic and lemon for 10 minutes.
2. Toss the sweet potato in oil and paprika; roast 30 minutes.
3. Roast the chicken 28–32 minutes until the skin crisps.
4. Add the beans for the final 12 minutes.

Bulk it up: Thighs over breast is deliberate here — more calories, more flavour, less dry chicken.



FREEZER READY

04

Chicken & Butternut Curry

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	MAKES
430 kcal	34 g	5

YOU NEED • 5 SERVINGS

- 700 g chicken breast, cubed
- 700 g butternut cubes
- 1 onion, garlic, ginger
- 2 tbsp curry powder, 1 tin coconut milk
- Spinach, rice to serve

METHOD

1. Fry onion, garlic and ginger, then bloom the curry powder for 30 seconds.
2. Seal the chicken on all sides.
3. Add coconut milk and butternut; simmer 20 minutes.
4. Wilt the spinach through off the heat.

Bulk it up: Serve on a full cup and a half of rice. Freeze in five containers and you have four nights covered.

Breakfast is where the **surplus** is won.

FRIDGE PREP

05



Peanut Butter & Banana Overnight Oats

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
420 kcal	16 g	5 min

YOU NEED • 1 SERVING

- 60 g oats
- 150 ml full-cream milk
- 1 tbsp peanut butter
- 1 banana, sliced
- Cinnamon, honey to taste

METHOD

1. Stir the oats and milk together in a jar until every oat is wet.
2. Swirl the peanut butter through in ribbons.
3. Seal and refrigerate overnight.
4. Top with banana and cinnamon in the morning.

Bulk it up: 90 g oats, 250 ml milk and 2 tbsp peanut butter turns this into a 700 kcal, 25 g protein breakfast.

FAST PROTEIN

06



Greek Yoghurt, Berries & Nuts

PER SERVING	PROTEIN	TIME
230 kcal	18 g	2 min

YOU NEED • 1 SERVING

- 200 g Greek yoghurt
- ½ cup berries or chopped fruit
- 1 tbsp mixed seeds
- 1 tbsp chopped nuts
- Optional: honey, oats to bulk

METHOD

1. Spoon the yoghurt into a jar with a proper lid.
2. Layer fruit, then seeds and nuts on top.
3. Seal and refrigerate — build three at a time.
4. Stir before eating. Nothing else required.

Bulk it up: Fold 40 g oats and a second tablespoon of nuts through for a 500 kcal, 25 g protein bowl.

THE CALORIES BETWEEN MEALS

Three snacks and one **honest** scale.

Most failed bulks aren't a meal problem — they're a gap problem. These three fill the gaps without needing a stove, and the rules on the right stop you from confusing a bad Tuesday with a bad month.

±120 KCAL EACH

Peanut butter & oat energy balls

1 cup oats, ½ cup peanut butter, ¼ cup honey, 2 tbsp seeds. Mix, roll into 12, chill 30 minutes. Keeps two weeks in the fridge, two months frozen.

±210 KCAL PER HANDFUL

Homemade trail mix

Equal parts mixed nuts, raisins and dried fruit, with a little dark chocolate. Portion it into small bags on Sunday — the packet is not a serving size.

±420 KCAL · 30 G PROTEIN

Banana & peanut butter shake

400 ml full-cream milk, 1 banana, 2 tbsp peanut butter, 40 g oats, cinnamon. Blend. The cheapest weight-gain shake in the country.

TRACK THESE FOUR, IGNORE THE REST

Bodyweight	3 mornings a week, weekly average only
Protein	Hit the daily number before anything else
Training	Load or reps must move over a month
Waist	Measure monthly — it tells you if the surplus is too big

ADJUST EVERY TWO WEEKS

Gaining too fast	Cut 200 kcal, mostly from fats
Not gaining	Add 200 kcal, mostly from carbs
Strength flat	Check sleep and total food before the programme
Feeling heavy	Hold the calories, add two easy cardio sessions

+200**KCAL ADJUSTMENT****2 weeks****BEFORE CHANGING****12 weeks****MINIMUM BLOCK****Weekly****AVERAGE, NOT DAILY**

This guide is general nutrition information for healthy adults, not medical or dietetic advice. If you are pregnant, managing a health condition, or working with a dietitian, check with them before changing how you eat.

A BULK IS MEASURED, NOT GUESSED

Log it, or you're just **eating more.**

A lean bulk lives or dies on whether you can see the trend. Log meals and macros, track your lifts and runs, and watch a twelve-week block turn into something you can actually point at.



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